

Winter Seats of Char Dham

During winters, when heavy snowfall leads to the closure of the sacred Char Dham shrines — Yamunotri, Gangotri, Kedarnath and Badrinath, the revered idols (Vigraha idols) are ceremonially brought to their nearby winter worship temples through a traditional Doli procession. For the next six months, daily worship and public darshan take place at these winter seats. This spiritual journey is known as the Winter Char Dham Yatra.

During this period, devotees receive the blessing of divine darshan without undertaking the challenging high-altitude trek, through more comfortable and accessible routes. The resonating beats of traditional Dandis, dhols and nagadas, along with vibrant local cultural rituals, offer pilgrims a unique and deeply moving spiritual atmosphere.

n addition, travelers get the opportunity to explore nearby religious landmarks, natural scenic spots and popular tourism destinations. The Winter Char Dham system not only celebrates faith, but also boosts the local economy, promoting homestays and rural tourism, and strengthening the livelihood of local communities.

